

Technical Architecture & AI Disclosure — HoneyMoney

Team JUST50 · Updated 27 August 2026 · [honeymoney.app](#)

Architecture — four layers, one graph

Layer	What runs	Why it matters
1. App	Next.js PWA	Any device, nothing to install.
2. Data	PocketBase knowledge graph — nodes, edges, transactions	Self-hostable single binary. Append-only, hash-chained ledger: a record is voided, never rewritten. No analytics SDKs.
3. Capture	On-device OCR and text parsing	Zero tokens, nothing transmitted. Six languages, multi-currency, no bank connection.
4. AI	Gemini Flash, Groq, or local Ollama	Switchable and optional, cost ledgered per call. No lock-in.

Every figure is computed, never composed

Ask Honey runs **parse** → **compute** → **narrate**. Deterministic code owns every number — the same `computeHScore` as the score screen, so chat and score cannot disagree. The model only phrases. Each number in its prose is checked against the computed set; one unrecognised figure and the whole answer is discarded for a template.

What a cloud model actually receives

A **local** engine gets full context — nothing leaves the machine. A **cloud** engine gets slot names, an intent and a locale: no figures, no labels, no free text. Figures are restored after the answer is checked. Image extraction is the exception: it sends the image you chose to scan.

Privacy, and its limits

AI is off until a household turns it on; consent is per purpose, recorded append-only, withdrawable, and enforced at the call site rather than the settings screen. Backups are **sealed in your browser** (AES-256-GCM; PBKDF2, 600,000 rounds) with a passphrase we never receive — we hold ciphertext and no key. The live database is not encrypted to us: the server computes your score over it. That line is documented, not implied. Private Spendings buckets stay out of shared views. One-click export. **We sell software, not data**: no brokerage, no advertising against records, no “anonymised insights” product.

Scope, limits, and how we built it

Honey answers about your own money. Product recommendation is regulated advice, routed to a licensed directory; an affordability question with no price asks for one. Allocation is rules-based and user-set — the AI moves no money and executes no transactions. OCR is imperfect and every extraction is confirmed before filing. Below 8 records or 14 days, Honey declines to project. Insights are **educational, not licensed advice**. We used AI coding assistants; architecture, financial logic and copy were reviewed and accepted by the team, on a public, non-backdated commit history.

Checkable, not merely stated: `check:ask` proves the model cannot introduce a number, `check:vault` that no plaintext survives into a backup, `check:capture` that what you type is what gets stored. If any statement here becomes inaccurate, we correct it — a capability left in a disclosure after it has left the code is the same defect as an undisclosed one.